services after the date of notification by the respective State Governments.
All Citizens of India between the age of 18 & 60 years as on the date of Submission of his/her application to point of presence (Pop)/ Point of Presence-Service Provider (POP-SP) can join NPS.
NRIs were also allowed to open National Pension Scheme (NPS) accounts online.

90. What is/are the advantage/advantages of implementing the 'National Agriculture Market' scheme?
1. It is a pan–India electronic trading portal for agricultural commodities.
2. It provides the farmers access to nationwide market, with prices commensurate with quality of their produce.

Select the answer using the code given below:
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans : (c) Both the statements in the question are correct. Prime Minister launched the National Agricultural Market scheme on 14th April 2016. It is the all India electronic trade portal for agricultural commodities that provides a nationwide market for farmers to ensure a consistent price for the quality of their produce.

91. With reference to the 'National Intellectual Property Rights Policy', consider the following statements:
1. It reiterates India's commitment to the Doha Development Agenda and the TRIPS Agreement.
2. Department of Industrial Policy and Promotion is the nodal agency for regulating intellectual property rights in India.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans : (c) National Intellectual Property Rights Policy approved by the Government of India on May 12, 2016 reflects India's commitment to the DOHA development Agenda and TRIPS Agreement. It is noteworthy that the Department of Industrial policy and promotion is a nodal agency for regulation of intellectual property rights in India.

92. With reference to 'Asia Pacific Ministerial Conference on Housing and Urban Development (APMCHUD)', consider the following statements:
1. The first APMCHUD was held in India in 2006 on the theme 'Emerging Urban Forms–Policy Responses and Governance Structure'.
2. India hosts all the Annual Ministerial Conferences in partnership with ADB, APEC and ASEAN.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans : (d)
1. The 1st APMCHUD was held in New Delhi India from 13th - 16th December 2006 on the theme of ' A vision for sustainable Urbanisation in the Asia Pacific by 2020'. The theme for the 6th Asia Pacific Ministerial conference on Housing & Urban Development (APMCHUD), New Delhi, India 2016 is "Emerging Urban Farms- Policy Responses and Governance structure".
2. The second Conference was held in Tehran, Iran.

MISCELLANEOUS

93. With reference to the 'Prohibition of Benami Property Transactions Act, 1988 (PBPT Act)', consider the following statements:
1. A property transaction is not treated as a benami transaction if the owner of the property is not aware of the transaction.
2. Properties held benami are liable for confiscation by the Government.
3. The Act provides for three authorities for investigations but does not provide for any appellate mechanism.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 2 and 3 only

Ans : (b) The Prohibition of Benami Property Transactions Act, 1988 (PBPT Act), defines Benami Transactions' prohibits them and further provides that violation of the PBPT Act is punishable with imprisonment and fine.
The definition of a benami transaction has been widened to include a transaction made in a fictitious name, where the owner is not aware or denies knowledge of the ownership of the property or the person providing the consideration for the property is not traceable. Properties held benami are liable for confiscation.
Properties held benami are liable for confiscation by the government without payment of compensation. An appellate mechanism has been provided under the PBPT Act in the form of Adjudicating Authority and Appellate Tribunal.

94. Consider the following pairs:

Traditions	Communities
1. Chaliha Sahib Festival	– Sindhis
2. Nanda Raj Jaat Yatra	– Gonds
3. Wari–Warkari	– Santhals

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) None of the above

Ans : (a) Statement 1: Chalisa /Chaliha also called Chaliha Sahib is a forty day long festival celebrated by Hindu Sindhi community.
Statement 2 : Nanda Devi Raj Jaat Yatra is a festival of Gharwali and Kumaoni people in Uttarkhand.
Statement 3 : Wari-Warkari or Varkari (Pandanpur wari) is a Maharashtrian festival celebrated by Marathas.

95. Which of the following gives 'Global Gender Gap Index' ranking to the countries of the world?
(a) World Economic Forum
(b) UN Human Rights Council
(c) UN Women
(d) World Health Organization

Ans : (a) Since 2006, the World Economic Forum has released the Global Gender Gap Index for the countries of the world. It is primarily an Index to measure gender equality. Through which gender inequality has to be eliminated, under which education, health and safety have been given priority.

96. Which reference to Manipuri Sankirtana, consider the following statements:
1. It is a song and dance performance.
2. Cymbals are the only musical instruments used in the performance.
3. It is performed to narrate the life and deeds of Lord of Lord Krishna.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1 only

Ans : (b) Sankirtana is one of the few important Indian heritage inscribed on the UNESCO Representative List of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity.
Statement 1 and 3 : Sankirtana performers narrate the lives and deeds of Krishna through ritual Singing drumming and dancing of Manipur. So both 1 and 3 are correct.
Statement 2 : Since drums are also used, statement 2 is incorrect.

97. Consider the following statements:
1. The Standard Mark of Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) is mandatory for automotive tyres and tubes.
2. AGMARK is a quality Certification Mark issued by the Food and Agriculture Organisation (FAO).

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans : (a) In 2010, a certification from the Bureau of Indian Statements (BIS) has been made mandatory for all types of automotive tyres and tubes.
AGMARK is a certification mark employed on agricultural products in India, assuring that they conform to a set of standards approved by the Directorate of Marketing and Inspection, an agency of the Government of India.

98. With reference to 'Quality Council of India (QCI)', consider the following statement:
1. QCI was set up jointly by the Government of India and the Indian Industry.
2. Chairman of QCI is appointed by the Prime Minister to the recommendations of the industry to the Government.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans : (c) The 'Quality' council of India' (QCI) established in the year 1997, was formed jointly by the Government of India and the Indian Industry. Its chairman is appointed by the Prime Minister on the recommendations made by the industry to the government. Thus, both the statements in question are true.

99. Which of the following is a most likely consequence of implementing the 'Unified Payments Interface (UPI)'?
(a) Mobile wallets will not be necessary for online payments.
(b) Digital currency will totally replace the physical currency in about two decades.
(c) FDI inflows will drastically increase.
(d) Direct transfer of subsidies to poor people will become very effective.

Ans : (a) UPI is a payment system that allows money transfer between any two bank accounts by using a Smartphone UPI allows a customer to pay directly from a bank account to different merchants, both online and offline, without the hassle of typing Credit Cards details, IFSC code or net banking/Wallet passwords.

100. The terms 'Event Horizon', 'Singularity', 'String Theory' and 'Standard Model' are sometimes seen in the news in the context of
(a) Observation and understanding of the Universe
(b) Study of the solar and the lunar eclipses
(c) Placing satellites in the orbit of the Earth
(d) Origin and evolution of living organisms on the Earth

Ans : (a) The terms **'Event Horizon'** explained as the boundary in space-time, 'Singularity' is defined as a location in space-time where the gravitational field of a celestial body becomes infinite. Both are related to Black Holes.
'String Theory' links together all physical aspects and 'Standard Model'- unifying the four fundamental forces, are related to the observation and understanding of the universe.